

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 4 2

♥ 10

♦ A 9 5 4 3

♣ 7 6

♠ A K 3

♥ A 7 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K J 3



♠ 9 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 10 5

♠ 7 5

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A Q 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦K. The ♦K holds the trick and East switches to the ♠9.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2/3

This looks like a walk in the park. Play 2 rounds of trumps, and if they split 3-2 go ahead and force the master trump out. The rest of the tricks would then be yours.

But West shows out on the second trump lead. Ouch!

DO NOT PLAY ANOTHER TRUMP! If you do, then East will pull all the trumps and then West/East will win some ♦s. Many, many ♦s.

Instead just start playing good ♣s. East can ruff in whenever he wants but you will maintain trump control. East can get both master trumps but nothing else.

It is usually correct to leave a master trump undrawn, just let the defender ruff in whenever he wants.

Here that principle applied even though there were **TWO** master trumps out.

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Again, never mind the ♣ suit. You have an 8-card Major fit and enough points for game, so you bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A 7 3
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ Q 10 5 2
 ♦ 9 7 4 2
 ♣ K 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6
 ♥ K 8 4
 ♦ A K 6
 ♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ 10 9 7 4
 ♥ J 9 6
 ♦ 10 8 5
 ♣ A Q J

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

A defender will definitely win this, and probably continue ♠s (but if they switch you would play the same way). You win the ♠ and play another ♣.

South wins and plays another ♠; you win and play another ♣. Deja vu.

South wins again, cashed his established ♠, and exits with a red card. You win and claim the rest of the tricks, including your now-established ♣.

You were able to establish a ♣ because that suit split 3-2.

And you did it without going down because the ♠s split 4-3.

This may seem lucky to you, but don't knock it, it was your **ONLY** chance.

With 12 points and no 4-card Major suit this one is easy. You bid 3NT of course.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠10 and North follows with the ♠2.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 8

There is just no way your ninth winner can come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♦s. So by process of elimination you have to get a ♣ trick.

Win the first trick, probably in your hand, and play a ♣.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 3

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 4 2

♣ 10 9 7 3

♠ J 6 2

♥ A K J 6 4 2

♦ K

♣ J 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ A Q 5

♥ Q 10 9 3

♦ A J 10 7

♣ A 8

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

Your partnership may play that a jump to 3♥ shows a 6-card suit with slam interest, in other words, this very hand. If you do, then bid it. If you don't, use a transfer first. Let's say you bid 2♦. Partner jumps to 3♥. Now

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You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least two Aces for his strong bidding. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and this is certainly not the type of hand where asking for Aces is always helpful - what if partner shows two Aces, aren't you going to bid the slam anyway? The advantage to Blackwood here is that there is just a slim possibility that partner has only one Ace!

You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♠. Next?

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The contract would be 6♥ played by North.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♣10. You play the ♣J, just in case West made a mistake, but East puts on the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

The ♠ loser is deceptive. You could discard a ♠ from dummy on your ♦A, but would still have a ♠ loser if the finesse doesn't work. Still, this would be one possible plan. Can you improve on that?

Maybe you can. Look harder at the ♦s. Win the ♣A, then play to dummy's ♦K. Pull trumps (2 rounds) ending in your hand. Play your ♦A, but discard a ♣ from dummy, (the key play). Now play your ♦J, and if West plays low, discard dummy's other ♣.

You have gotten rid of the ♣ losers, but if East can win the ♦Q on this trick you will discard a ♠ on the ♦10, but will still have to try the ♠ finesse.

But, if the ♦J holds then it won't matter if the ♠ finesse works or not, you will make the slam.

Suppose when you play your ♦J West puts on the ♦Q.

No problem. You ruff in dummy, come back to your hand with a trump and **THEN** discard dummy's last ♣